Heidelberg University
Information Sheet for Student Exchange Program 2027-28

Name of University	**Universität Heidelberg** (Heidelberg University)   
Official websites	www.uni-heidelberg.de/en www.uni-heidelberg.de/university/
Exchange-related information	German: www.uni-heidelberg.de/international-exchange English: www.uni-heidelberg.de/en/study/international-studies/studying-in-heidelberg/destination-heidelberg
	Winter semester: **October 1st to March 31st** **Summer semester:** **April 1st to September 30st** Preparatory Language Course: September or March, 4 weeks 80+ hours of instruction all levels Lecture Period: http://www.uni-heidelberg.de/courses/date/dates.html
Exchange Coordinator for students from Central and Eastern Europe, Near East, Africa	
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Application	
Nomination deadline	Fall / Winter: May 15 Spring / Summer: November 15
Application deadline	Fall / Winter: June 15 Spring / Summer: December 15
Application procedure	**Nomination** with relevant information of the exchange students by their home university by Email (Name, Email, Subject Area, study semester, language skills). Heidelberg International Relations Office will then send out information on the **Online Application for exchange students**. Students will have to fill out the application form for admission online, print it, sign it and upload it again.

Application documents	A signed copy of the **online application form** for admission has to be uploaded. Students need to indicate on the online form that they wish to • register for the German preparatory language course • apply for student housing. In addition to the online application form, exchange students need to **upload** the following items for formal admission: • University transcripts • Passport-size photograph After the application has been processed, a **letter of admission** will be issued around June/July for Fall and January/February for Spring.
Suggested length of study for exchange	For a successful exchange experience, we recommend a study stay of one to two semesters. Furthermore, we strongly recommend the participation in the preparatory German language course before lecture start (September or March see information below). 
Procedure of applying for student visa	Information on visa procedure for Germany can be found here www.auswaertiges-amt.de/en/visa-service Generally, citizens of the USA, Canada, Japan, Australia, New Zealand, South Korea, Israel and EFTA countries usually do not need a VISA to travel to Germany but need to apply for their residence permit after their arrival in Germany. Citizens of other countries have to apply well in advance for their VISA before travelling to Germany! Documents needed from home to apply for a residence permit: • Letter of sufficient funding from bank; notarized parental letter • Proof of health insurance (German state Health insurance or sufficient health insurance coverage if provided from home country)
Academics	
Programs and courses offered to exchange students	A list of study fields offered at Heidelberg University can be found at www.uni-heidelberg.de/en/study/all-subjects Programs not available to exchange students are courses offered at the school of medicine and dentistry. Restrictions may apply for some courses in biosciences or biotechnology, and for some courses in law. Exceptions can be made with the permission from the coordinator and the faculty in Heidelberg. Please note that Heidelberg University does not offer programs in Business, Agriculture, or at a college of Music/ Arts and only partly programs in Engineering.
Course Catalog 	Most information on the course offerings for the coming semester will be available online only a few months before the lecture periods starts. However, course catalogs from previous semesters give a general overview of the courses offered at Heidelberg University and commented course list, on the institutes web pages. You can find the online curriculum (current and past terms) here: https://heico.uni-heidelberg.de Please go directly to *'courses'* ⇨ Picture with students (no need to LogIn). You can find the different departments under "Organisation - Heidelberg University"; the current and previous semester programs under 'Term'. The language of instruction can be chosen via the filter function.

Language of Instruction 	Typically, the language of instruction is German. Therefore, a (good) knowledge of **German** is helpful and students may choose the exchange stay to get or improve their knowledge of German. However, there are several fields of study with a (large) variety of **courses taught in English**: i.e. English Studies, American Studies, Economics, South Asian Studies, and Transcultural Studies. There are also a few courses offered in English in Sociology, Political Science and Psychology. www.uni-heidelberg.de/en/study/all-subjects Many Masters programs are taught (fully or partly) in English. Some of these courses may also be available for advanced Bachelor students. Study Programs in English Information on all Master Courses To search for **courses taught in English** please go to **heiCo Campus Online** https://heico.uni-heidelberg.de You do not need to login; you can go directly to '***courses'*** => click on the picture with students. The language of instruction can be chosen via the filter function.
German Language Instruction	
Preparatory German Language course	We strongly encourage exchange students to register for the **4-week intensive German language course at the International Study Center (ISZ).** The course is offered **before the start of the semester,** in September for fall semester students and in March for spring semester students. Attending the course will not only improve the language skills, but also help to become familiar with Heidelberg University and build a new circle of friends before the lecture period starts. The program includes 80 hours of language instruction at all levels (basic, intermediate and advanced). All courses contain exercises dealing with German grammar, conversation, reading and writing, listening comprehension, lexis, phonetics, regional and cultural studies, and information about studying in Heidelberg. www.isz.uni-heidelberg.de/e_courses_vdk.html **The fee for the preparatory language course is covered by the International Relations Office for exchange students, Erasmus+ KA 171 students receive a waiver**
German Language Instruction 	Students who want further training for their German language proficiency **during the lecture period** are offered a large variety of different language programs at the University's International Study Center (ISZ). They may choose between a 4- and an 8-hour per week general German language course or/ and can select subject-related German courses. These courses complement the regular courses of all study subjects offered at Heidelberg University.

Intercultural German Studies ***Germanistik in Kulturvergleich***	The Institute for German as a Foreign Language Philology (IDF) offers degree programs for non-native German speakers as well as a wide variety of courses especially developed for exchange students, e.g. courses geared to improve both language competencies as well a large variety of German studies courses (Literature, Art, Cultural Studies, Linguistics, History, etc.). Please see: www.idf.uni-heidelberg.de/index.html 
Student Life	
Accommodation 	Exchange students in bilateral programs as well as Erasmus+ KA 171 students are privileged to receive guaranteed student housing. Living in student residences is the most affordable and most convenient way of living in Heidelberg as an exchange student. The private housing market in Heidelberg is very tight. Therefore, all exchange students are encouraged to consider living in student residences by the Studierendenwerk Heidelberg. Types of accommodation: • single room sharing kitchen and bathrooms in groups of 2 – 4 • single room in dormitories with kitchens and bathrooms on each floor • small number of single apartments More information: www.stw.uni-heidelberg.de/en/wohnheime
Fees of student housing	Range of rent: approx. 270 – 560 EURO per Month; plus 650 EURO refundable deposit per stay
Special housing needs	Students who have special housing needs due to a disability, allergy or other health problems are kindly asked to inform the exchange coordinator and indicate this on their application.
Cost of Living / Financial Planning	Approx. 1.000 EURO per month. Please refer to the information for financial planning given on this website: www.uni-heidelberg.de/en/study/international-studies/studying-in-heidelberg/destination-heidelberg/preparing-your-stay
Insurances 	**Health insurance** with unlimited coverage is compulsory for all Heidelberg University students. Exchange Students are advised to take out health insurance in Germany (a highly comprehensive coverage), or to ensure to bring full and unlimited health insurance coverage from their country of residence. **Please note: Students who plan to stay longer than one semester in Heidelberg need to take out German Health insurance coverage!** **Price of comprehensive State Health Insurance** per month: approx.150 EURO* * Students aged 30 and above do not qualify for state health insurance and have to purchase private insurance. **Accident insurance and Personal Liability insurance** (*Haftpflichtversicherung*) are highly recommended for the exchange stay in Germany, as well as **extra (health) insurance coverage** at home for the period between arrival and enrolment at Heidelberg University. **Further information on insurances:** www.uni-heidelberg.de/en/study/international-studies/studying-in-heidelberg/destination-heidelberg/health-and-insurance
Detailed Information for Exchange students	Further detailed information for Incoming Exchange Students **www.uni-heidelberg.de/international-exchange** Information for Erasmus KA 171 Incoming: https://www.uni-heidelberg.de/en/international-affairs/erasmus/incoming